**25901533** **Reg.No : .....**

**Name : .....**

# MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

## MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

## Fourth SEMESTER

## Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCSOC201 - MODERN SOCIOLOGICAL THEORIES

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

**Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes** **Maximum Marks: 50**

***Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)***

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

### Part A

Short Answer

Answer any **13** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Identify one example of a latent function in the education system. [U] / [CO1]
2. Explain the basic assumptions of conflict perspective [K] / [CO2]
3. Indicate one way in which dysfunction may weaken social stability. [An] / [CO1]
4. Who was George Herbert Mead? [K] / [CO3]
5. State the difference between intended and unintended consequences in functional analysis. [K] / [CO1]
6. How do individuals acquire social behaviour in everyday life? [K] / [CO3]
7. What is meant by “significant symbols”? [A] / [CO3]
8. Who is considered the chief architect of structural functionalismand why? [K] / [CO1]
9. How can Symbolic Interactionism be empirically examined? [U] / [CO3]
10. Examine the concept domination in conflict perspective [U] / [CO2]

11. How do significant symbols reduce misunderstanding in communication? [An] / [CO3]

12. Give one argument suggesting functionalism underestimates social conflict. [E] / [CO6]

13. Define the concept of “structure” in structuralist theory. [U] / [CO4]

14. How does the social environment shape the self? [K] / [CO3]

15. What are the two components of a linguistic sign? [U] / [CO4]

16. Differentiate between mind and self in Symbolic Interactionism. [K] / [CO3]

**[2x13 = 26]**

## Part B

Short Essay

Answer all questions

Each question carries **6** marks

17a. Analyse Lewis A. Coser’s functional theory of conflict. [C] / [CO2]

OR

17b. Apply structuralist concepts to explain patterns in language or cultural practices. [A] / [CO4]

18a. Trace the intellectual foundations of functionalism in classical sociology [K] / [CO1]

OR

18b. Evaluate the functional and dysfunctional aspects of conflict in society. [An] / [CO6]

19a. Compare Parsons’ voluntaristic theory of social action with the concept of the unit act. [An] / [CO1]

OR

19b. Discuss the role of society in the formation of the self according to Cooley. [U] / [CO3]

20a. Evaluate the relevance of the Conflict Perspective in explaining social change. [E] / [CO2]

OR

20b. Compare linguistic structures and kinship structures in structuralist analysis [E] / [CO4]

**[6x4 = 24]**